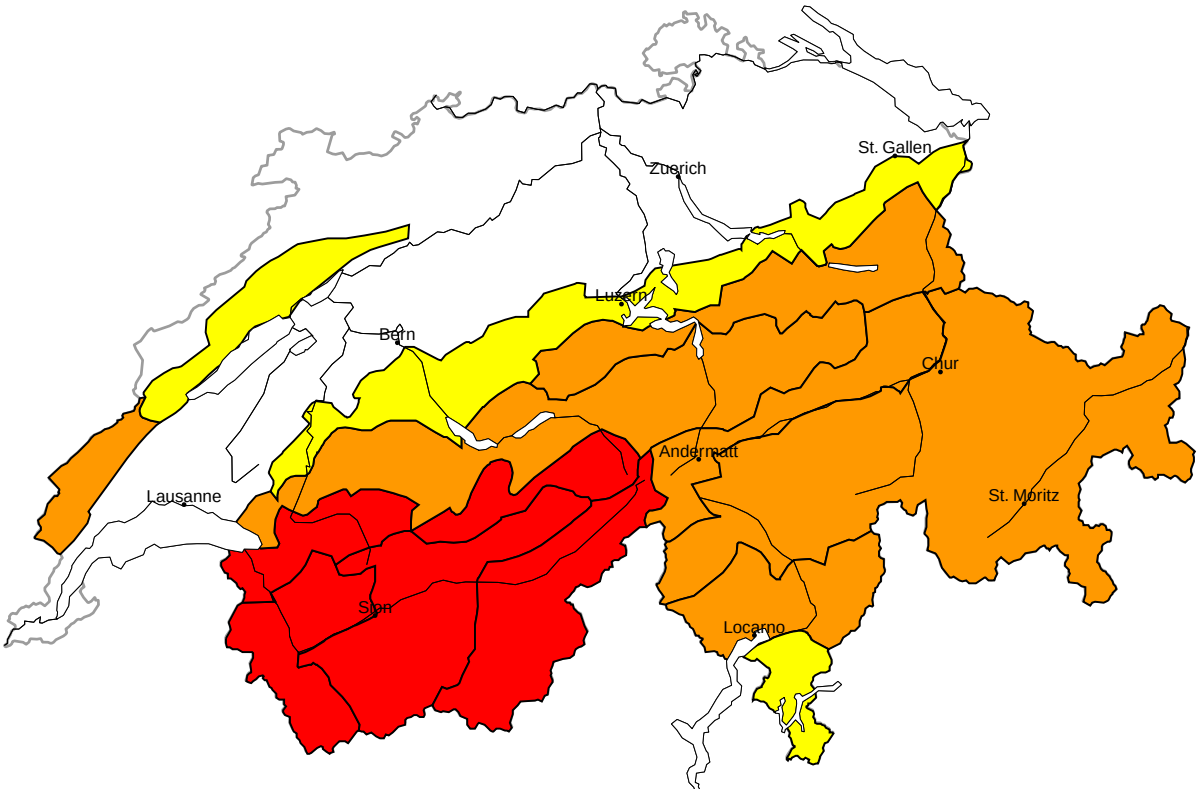
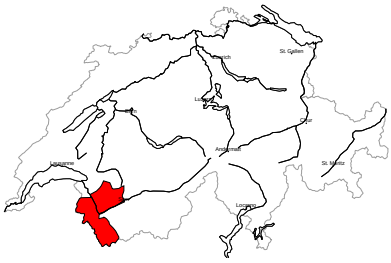
Avalanche danger

updated on 12.2.2026, 17:00



Danger levels 1 low 2 moderate 3 considerable 4 high 5 very high

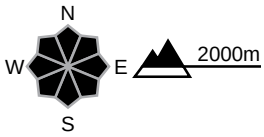
region A



High (4+)

New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

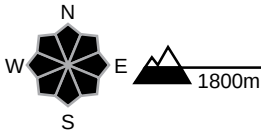


Danger description
Large quantities of fresh snow and the wind-drifted snow are lying on top of a weakly bonded old snowpack. As a consequence of the heavy snowfall more natural avalanches are to be expected, in particular during the first half of the night. They can in many cases reach very large size. In the typical avalanche paths in particular avalanches can reach as far as the valley bottom and endanger transportation routes. Including in starting zones in which avalanches have already been released natural avalanches must be expected.
Avalanches can be released, even by a single winter sport participant. The snow sport conditions outside marked and open pistes are dangerous.

Moderate (2)

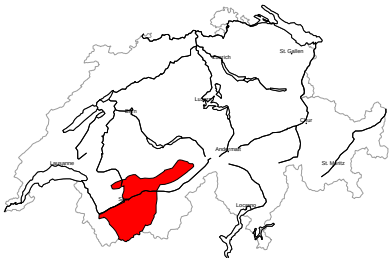
Wet snow

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Wet snow slides and avalanches are possible, in particular on very steep slopes. These can in some cases reach medium size. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised in particular in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.

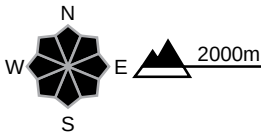
region B



High (4=)

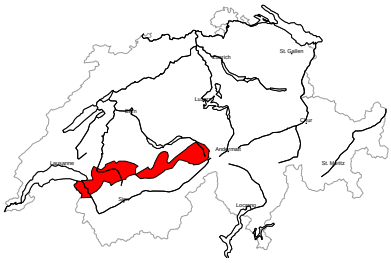
New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Large quantities of fresh snow and the wind-drifted snow are lying on top of a weakly bonded old snowpack. More natural avalanches are possible, in particular during the first half of the night. They can reach very large size. Exposed parts of transportation routes can be endangered.
Avalanches can in many places be released, even by a single winter sport participant. The conditions are dangerous for backcountry touring and other off-piste activities outside marked and open pistes.

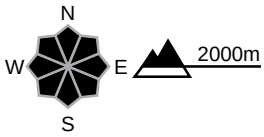
region C



High (4-)

New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

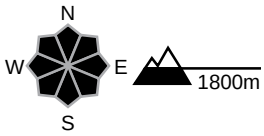


Danger description
The fresh snow as well as the sometimes large wind slabs are prone to triggering. Individual natural avalanches are to be expected, in particular during the first half of the night. They can penetrate deep layers and reach very large size in isolated cases. Exposed parts of transportation routes can be endangered. Single winter sport participants can release avalanches easily. The snow sport conditions outside marked and open pistes are very critical.

Moderate (2)

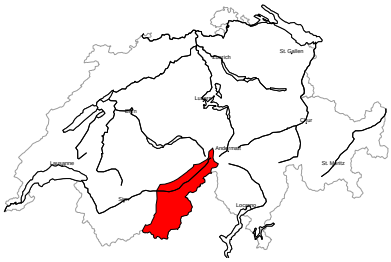
Wet snow

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Wet snow slides and avalanches are possible, in particular on very steep slopes. These can in some cases reach medium size. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised in particular in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.

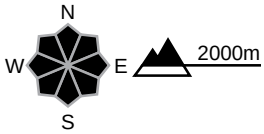
region D



High (4-)

New snow, Persistent weak layers

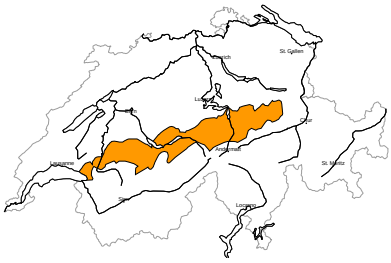
Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
The fresh snow as well as the sometimes large wind slabs are prone to triggering. Individual natural avalanches are to be expected, in particular during the first half of the night. They can penetrate deep layers and reach very large size in isolated cases. Exposed parts of transportation routes can be endangered. Single winter sport participants can release avalanches easily. The snow sport conditions outside marked and open pistes are very critical.

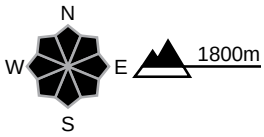
region E

Considerable (3+)



New snow, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations

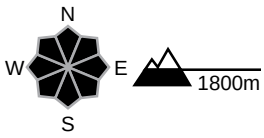


Danger description
The new snow and wind slabs are prone to triggering. Until the early morning individual natural avalanches are to be expected. Avalanches can be released, even by a single winter sport participant. They can in some cases penetrate deep layers and reach large size. Backcountry touring calls for experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

Moderate (2)

Wet snow

Avalanche prone locations



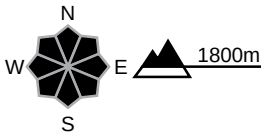
Danger description
Wet snow slides and avalanches are possible, in particular on very steep slopes. These can in some cases reach medium size. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised in particular in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.

region F

Considerable (3+)

New snow, Persistent weak layers

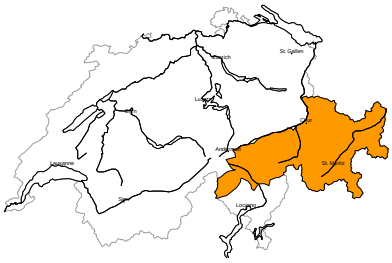
Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
The new snow and wind slabs are prone to triggering. Until the early morning individual natural avalanches are to be expected. Avalanches can be released, even by a single winter sport participant. They can in some cases penetrate deep layers and reach large size. Backcountry touring calls for experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

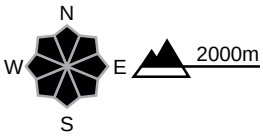
region G

Considerable (3+)



Wind slab, Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



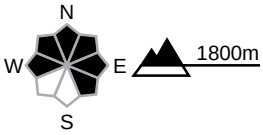
Danger description
The new snow and wind slabs will be deposited on a weakly bonded old snowpack. Avalanches can be triggered in deep layers and reach large size in isolated cases. The avalanche prone locations are prevalent. Remotely triggered avalanches are to be expected. Whumpfing sounds and the formation of shooting cracks when stepping on the snowpack and fresh avalanches indicate the danger.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for extensive experience in the assessment of avalanche danger and restraint.

region H

Considerable (3=)

Wind slab

Avalanche prone locations

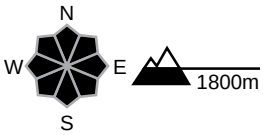


Danger description
The fresh wind slabs are prone to triggering. Avalanches can be released by a single winter sport participant. They can in isolated cases penetrate deep layers and reach quite a large size.
Backcountry touring calls for experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

Moderate (2)

Wet snow

Avalanche prone locations



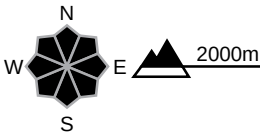
Danger description
Wet snow slides and avalanches are possible, in particular on very steep slopes. These can in some cases reach medium size. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised in particular in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.

region I

Considerable (3=)

Persistent weak layers

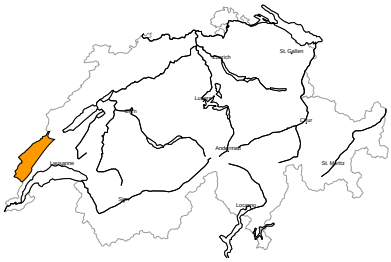
Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
The new snow and wind slabs of the last three days are lying on top of a weakly bonded old snowpack. Even single winter sport participants can release avalanches. These can be triggered in deep layers and reach large size in isolated cases. Remotely triggered avalanches are possible. Whumpfing sounds and the formation of shooting cracks when stepping on the snowpack and fresh avalanches can indicate the danger.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for extensive experience in the assessment of avalanche danger.

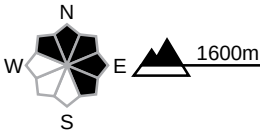
region J

Considerable (3-)



Wind slab

Avalanche prone locations

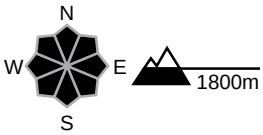


Danger description
The fresh wind slabs are in some cases prone to triggering. Avalanches can be released by people. They can reach medium size. The wind slabs are to be evaluated with care and prudence in particular in very steep terrain.

Moderate (2)

Wet snow

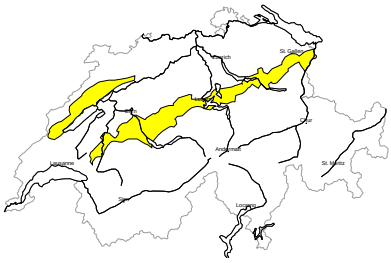
Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Wet snow slides and avalanches are possible, in particular on very steep slopes. These can in some cases reach medium size. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised in particular in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.

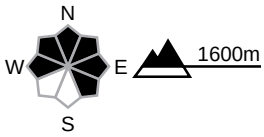
region K

Moderate (2+)



Wind slab

Avalanche prone locations

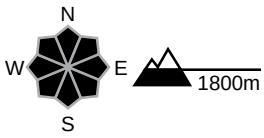


Danger description
The fresh wind slabs are in some cases prone to triggering. Avalanches can in some places be released by people. They can reach medium size. The wind slabs are to be evaluated with care and prudence in particular in very steep terrain.

Moderate (2)

Wet snow

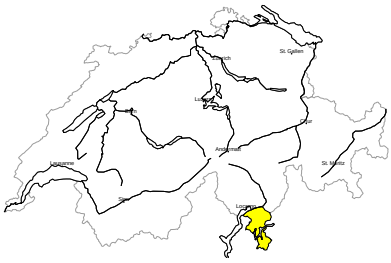
Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Wet snow slides and avalanches are possible, in particular on very steep slopes. These can in some cases reach medium size. Apart from the danger of being buried, restraint should be exercised in particular in view of the danger of avalanches sweeping people along and giving rise to falls.

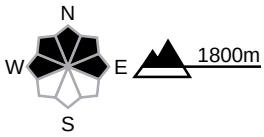
region L

Moderate (2+)



Persistent weak layers

Avalanche prone locations



Danger description
Distinct weak layers exist in the old snowpack. Avalanches can in some places be released by a single winter sport participant. Avalanches can be triggered in deep layers and reach medium size.
Backcountry touring and other off-piste activities call for defensive route selection.

Snowpack and weather

updated on 12.2.2026, 17:00

Snowpack

- Westernmost Lower Valais, northern Valais, Vaud Alps: A lot of the new and drifted snow is prone to triggering. It lies on an old snowpack with weak layers in places in the central part of the snowpack. With the end of the precipitation on Friday morning, the naturally occurring slab avalanche activity will be appreciably reduced. However, isolated naturally triggered avalanches may still become very large.
- Southern Valais, Ticino, Grisons: the old snowpack is very weak and contains distinct weak layers in the middle and lower part of the snowpack that are prone to triggering. Avalanches can easily be triggered by human activity in these layers and fractures in the snowpack can propagate over long distances. Avalanches may become very large, especially in southern Valais, where a lot of new snow and drifted snow is lying on the weak old snowpack from the last few days.
- Central and eastern parts of the northern flank of the Alps: there are also weak layers in the old snowpack in these regions. However, avalanches in these layers are less frequent and the main danger comes from the new and drifted snow. Below approximately 1800 m, the snowpack has been soaked by the sometimes intense rain.

Weather review for Thursday

Precipitation continued to fall in the west and north. Overnight to Thursday, the snowfall level was around 1800 m on the northern flank of the Alps and fell to 1200 to 1500 m in all regions during the day. In the Engadine, it was partly sunny in the late morning.

Fresh snow
From Wednesday afternoon to Thursday afternoon, the following amounts of fresh snow fell above approximately 2200 m:
- Westernmost Lower Valais, northern Valais: 40 to 60 cm;
- Rest of Valais, rest of northern Alpine ridge west of the Grimsel Pass: 20 to 40 cm
- Remaining western and central parts of the northern flank of the Alps, western Ticino: 15 to 30 cm; elsewhere less or dry.

In total, the following amounts of snow have fallen above 2200 m since the onset of precipitation on Tuesday:
- Westernmost Lower Valais, northern Lower Valais: 80 to 120 cm
- Vaud and Fribourg Alps, the rest of northern Lower Valais, the rest of the northern Alpine ridge west of the Grimsel Pass: 40 to 80 cm
- Remaining western and central parts of the northern flank of the Alps, western Ticino, southern Upper Valais: 30 to 50 cm
- Eastern part of the northern flank of the Alps, northern Grisons, rest of Ticino: 15 to 30 cm, less elsewhere

Temperature
At midday at 2000 m, around -2 °C

Wind
- Often strong southwesterly winds during the night
- During the day strong to storm force in the west and north, elsewhere moderate from west to northwest

Weather forecast to Friday

During the first half of the night, heavy precipitation will continue to fall in the north. The snowfall level will be between 1000 and 1200 m. In the late morning, it will initially be quite sunny in all regions before clouds move in from the west.

Fresh snow
From Thursday afternoon to Friday morning above 1600 m:
- Western Jura, westernmost Lower Valais, northern Alpine ridge from Les Diablerets to the Tödi: 15 to 25 cm
- Rest of Lower Valais, rest of the northern flank of the Alps, northern Grisons: 10 to 15 cm
- Elsewhere less, dry along the central southern flank of the Alps

Temperature
At midday at 2000 m, around -2 °C

Wind
- Strong to storm force from the northwest during the night
- During the day moderate to strong in the west at high altitudes, otherwise light to moderate from the southwest

Outlook to Sunday

On Saturday, it will be very cloudy in all regions and there will be some precipitation at times; in the south this will occur mainly during the night, while in the north it will be during the day. The snowfall level in the south will be around 1000 to 1200 m, while in the north it will drop down to low altitudes. On Sunday there will be some more precipitation in the north with sunny spells in the afternoon. Conditions will be quite sunny in the south. There will be a strong to storm force northerly wind in the south overnight to Sunday.
The avalanche danger will decrease in the west, but will not change significantly in the other regions.